

Dicerorhinus sumatrensis

Sumatran rhinoceros

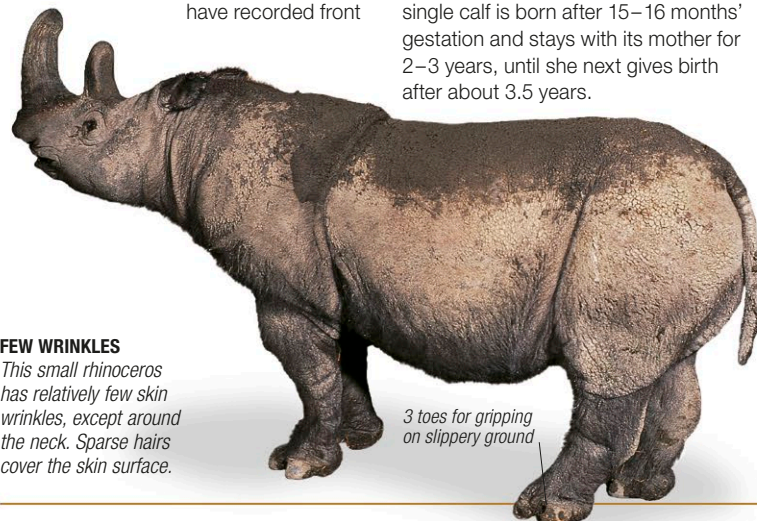


Length 8¼–10 ft
(2.5–3.2 m)
Tail Not recorded
Weight Up to 2,095 lb
(950 kg)
Social unit Individual
Status Critically endangered

Location S. and S.E. Asia



Solitary and secretive, this is the smallest and hairiest rhinoceros. It rests in wallows by day and browses at night on twigs, leaves, and fruit, also felling saplings for tender shoots. Its high-altitude habitat, once relatively safe, is now being lost to loggers; horn poachers are also a major threat—museum specimens have recorded front



FEW WRINKLES
This small rhinoceros has relatively few skin wrinkles, except around the neck. Sparse hairs cover the skin surface.

WALLOWING



The Sumatran rhinoceros, like all rhinoceroses, hippopotamuses, and similar sparsely haired mammals, wallows in mud, which dries onto the skin. This is cooling and also protects its delicate surface areas from flies and other biting insects.

horn lengths of up to 16 in (40 cm). A single calf is born after 15–16 months' gestation and stays with its mother for 2–3 years, until she next gives birth after about 3.5 years.

Rhinoceros sondaicus

Javan rhinoceros



Length 9¼–11 ft
(3–3.5 m)
Tail Not recorded
Weight Up to 1½ tons
(1.4 tonnes)
Social unit Individual
Status Critically endangered

Location S.E. Asia



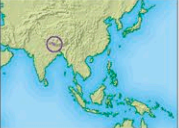
One of the most rare large mammals, this species is hairless other than on its ears and tail tip. Its thick, gray skin is divided by deep folds to make a "saddle" over the



neck with lumps or nodules giving an armor-plated effect. The single horn rarely exceeds 10 in (25 cm) long and is lacking in some females. It is largely nocturnal, possibly due to the threat of poachers. It eats a wide range of plants. The Javan—or lesser one-horned—rhinoceros was decimated by lowland forest removal. Two remnant populations survive, taking advantage of coastal mangrove and bamboo marshes. Very little is known about the mating habits of the Javan rhinoceros. As in other species, the male is probably territorial, marking his area with dung piles and urine pools. It is thought that one calf is born and that it stays with its mother for 2 years, possibly longer.

Rhinoceros unicornis

Indian rhinoceros



Length Up to 11 ft
(3.3–3.5 m)
Tail 26 in
(66 cm)
Weight Up to 2 tons
(2 tonnes)
Social unit Individual
Status Vulnerable

Location S. Asia
(Brahmaputra Valley)



Like other rhinoceros species, the Indian rhinoceros is generally solitary except for temporary male–female associations when mating, and a mother with her calf. Both male and female have a single horn, up to 24 in (60 cm) long. Males have larger, sharp, tusklike incisors for fighting rivals at breeding time. Otherwise they usually tolerate intruders into their ranges, which vary from ¾–3 square miles (2–8 square km) depending on the quality of habitat. The gestation period is 16

months and the calf may remain with its mother until her next offspring is born, which may be 3 years later. In 2005, only 2,575 animals were left, although the population is now increasing. Despite protection projects and an encouraging recovery in numbers, remaining populations of the species are scattered and fragmented, and therefore still at some risk. These animals are also still subject to poaching for their horns and other body parts.

PLATES AND RIVETS



The Indian rhinoceros's skin has deep folds, its armor-plated appearance accentuated by tubercles (lumps), especially on the sides and rear, which resemble rivets. The pink skin within the folds is prone to parasites that are removed by egrets and tick birds, who also act as sentinels.



gray-brown coloration

deep skin folds

IN THE TALL GRASS



Tall grasses make up the bulk of the Indian rhinoceros's diet (they grow to 26 ft/8 m tall during the wet season, giving excellent cover). This species feeds mainly by twilight and darkness, curling its upper lip around the stems to bend and bite off the tender tips. It is also the most aquatic rhinoceros, wading and swimming with ease.